

EMPATHY: The Pursuit of Joy

*What settles a nun in meditation and a man in a maximum-security cell?
From the Dalai Lama's monasteries in Dharamshala to a chaplaincy at
Rikers Island — the first film that doesn't just document the medicine. It
delivers it, and measures the dose.*

WHAT IT IS

A 90-minute feature + series led by bestselling author **Dr. Natalie Petouhoff** (*Empathy in Action*), director **Josh Sikkema**, and Grammy-nominated composer **Maejor** — with neuroscientists at Harvard, Columbia, Rutgers, and UC San Diego. Real people — monks, maximum-security prisoners, doctors, mothers — and a scientifically composed soundtrack recorded with the Dalai Lama's music school. Every piece is both medicine and instrument: built, measured, revised, tested.

WHY IT WINS

The problem: the wise choice loses at the moment of need — the scroll, the drink, the cart are engineered; 3,000-year-old practice never got a delivery system.

The method: *public translation* — audience embedded in production from day one; empathy as R&D, science as the passport.

The proof: before/after measurement on real audiences, a peer-reviewed paper, co-regulation outcomes — what survives a skeptical room.

THE FIELD (AND THE DIFFERENCE)

Wellness documentary is a proven category — *Heal, The Mindfulness Movement, My Octopus Teacher*-class breakouts show the appetite. None of them measured their own effect, built for skeptics instead of the converted, or shipped with a distribution network already standing. This one does all three.

FIVE WAYS IT EARNS

- 1 • **Screenings** — event-based, measured, community-hosted worldwide
- 2 • **Curriculum licensing** — schools, well-being orgs, corporate
- 3 • **Sound-bath audio** — subscription soundtrack, binaural + breath-paced
- 4 • **Immersive experience** — ticketed installation (concept art on request)
- 5 • **Community commerce** — fan funding + merch, zero-inventory

TRACTION — ALREADY REAL

Shot: Dharamshala, monk-and-scientist sessions, Rikers chaplaincy

Trailer: cut and screening now

Emory endorsement in progress; grant submitted (Templeton)

Network: researchers, practitioners, educators already screening prototypes — the distribution is pre-built

Oct 2026: production audience with His Holiness the Dalai Lama

THE ASK — THREE COMPLETE TIERS

PROOF • \$250-400K

Finish feature edit · measurement round · festival + impact run

TRANSLATION • \$750K-1.2M

+ soundtrack completion · vertical content engine · series pilot

CATEGORY • \$2-3M

+ series package · immersive build · global screening + curriculum program

Four lanes open: grants · equity · brand sponsorship · community. Detailed line budget under NDA.

WHAT THE MONEY DOES

Production completion (edit, score, sound design) · science (measurement, analysis, publication) · translation engine (formats, vertical content) · engagement (screenings, curriculum, network activation) · paying professionals their asking price.